

Hello

After Google Talk, Hello is another Instant Messaging (IM) service by Google, with a different take. It is an application for sharing digital images with friends—no Web sites and no e-mail required to share your photos with Hello. The only requirement is that both the sender and receiver need to have the Hello program installed. Get it at www.hello.com.

Picasa launched the Hello service under the Google's umbrella to share photos using P2P. You can share with your friend while chatting—no resizing high-quality photos or wasting time waiting for the images to upload. Blogger users can also upload photos and add captions directly through Hello. It also has Bloggerbot, which is in your buddy list, and directly uploads photos to your Blogger blog. At present, Hello only supports JPEG files.

14.1 What It Does

You can send images using IM and simultaneously add comments and chat with your friend. The receiver will receive images in a few seconds (depending on your connection), and then the images can be saved or printed. If you're well-versed with IM messengers, then using Hello should be a piece of cake.

Hello's only drawback is that you can't share pictures with more than one user at the same time. But it can be used with or without Picasa, even though it's a Picasa product—photos for transfer can be selected from Picasa directly.

Your photos and chat are secure, as the application connects you by peer to peer networking even when your firewall is on. All chat and photos transferred are protected with 128-bit Advanced Encryption Standard (AES) encryption.